Dr Srivas Chennu

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Summary

Senior applied ML research leader with over 15 years of experience spanning academia and industry. Lead a team of AI/ML scientists at Apple. Have delivered scalable user experiences across Apple services powered by generative AI and personalization. Previously led academic research in health AI/ML at Cambridge and Kent, publishing ~100 peer-reviewed papers with 4800+ citations (h-index: 34, as of Jan 2026).

Key Qualifications

- 15+ years leading complex ML R&D in both academic and industry settings.
- Lead team of researchers and engineers working on applied research projects.
- Head of ML at marketing optimization start-up acquired by Apple.
- Extensive hands-on experience with Python ML stack for building AI applications.
- Have delivered large-scale user-facing features for driving business growth.
- Have led the introduction of generative AI powered experiences.
- Responsible for technical planning, feature delivery and cross-functional alignment.
- Seasoned communicator, regularly provide strategic updates to senior leadership.

Technical Skills

- **Languages**: Python, C++, MATLAB, SQL, Java
- **ML Techniques**: Probabilistic RL, Bayesian inference, Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Time Series Analysis, Generative AI
- **Domains**: Recommender Systems, Big Data, Distributed Systems, Health AI
- **Tools**: PyTorch, Tensorflow, NumPyro, scikit-learn, Git, Docker

Professional Experience

Apple — Senior Research Manager (2023–present)

- Lead applied science teams building retrieval and ranking systems for personalized and generative AI experiences across multiple Apple services, including the App Store, Arcade, TV, Podcasts and Fitness.
- Collaborated with engineering and design to deploy scalable AI/ML powered solutions with business impact totaling 100s of millions.
- Directed adoption of generative AI in the core App Store product, navigating organizational transitions.
- Published research in ACM RecSys 2024 and 2025, authored patent applications.

Apple — Research Manager (2019–23)

- Delivered ML-powered features to optimize user acquisition, engagement, and retention across Apple services.
- Built Bayesian inference framework that powers App Store A/B testing platform for app developers, published papers at KDD and DSAA, authored patent application.
- Co-led development of interpretable reinforcement learning models for user behavior optimization.

DataTiger (Acquired by Apple) — Head of ML (2018)

- Applied ensemble and unsupervised ML models for retention and personalized marketing in the gaming industry.

Universities of Kent and Cambridge — Assistant Professor, Research Lead (2010–19)

- Led health AI research to understand neural mechanisms of human consciousness.
- Created MOHAWK software for identifying biomarkers of consciousness, used in multiple clinical centers for diagnostics.
- Secured independent NIHR and EPSRC research grants
- Published in New England Journal of Medicine, IEEE, Brain, PLOS Comp Biol.
- Research featured in Scientific American, Wired, BBC and New Scientist.

Education

- PhD in Computational Neuroscience — University of Kent (2006–2009)
- MSc in Information and Communication Systems — Hamburg University of Technology (2004–2006)
- BEng in Computer Science and Engineering — Visveswaraiah Technological University (1998–2002)

Selected Publications

Personalization and optimization

- Scalarized Efficient Multi-Objective Recommendations. ACM RecSys, 2025
- Rapid and Scalable Bayesian AB Testing. IEEE DSAA, 2023
- Smooth Sequential Optimisation. ACM SIGKDD Workshop, 2021

Neuroscience and Health AI

- Cognitive motor dissociation in disorders of consciousness, NEJM, 2024
- Prediction of Anaesthetic Unconsciousness using 3D CNNs. IEEE EMBS, 2020
- Brain networks in disorders of consciousness. Brain, 2017